

An opening filled, without chasing replies

“Making sure it moves to the next person without double-booking would matter most.”

Lena, customer discovery conversation

The problem you described

Square shows the cancellation. The spreadsheet identifies possible clients. Manual texts leave you tracking replies instead of reaching the next suitable person.

Our proposal

Give one eligible client a clear offer and deadline. Let the system follow up automatically, while you and Carla keep control.

The business goal: fewer empty appointments and less staff checking, with no competing claims inside the offer process.

Why we chose one offer at a time

“But avoiding competing acceptances matters more; one at a time is safer if it keeps moving automatically.”

Lena, customer discovery conversation

Alternative: text several clients

Benefit

Reach more people immediately.

Cost

Competing replies need a winner and an explanation to everyone else. Staff still reconcile the outcome.

The tradeoff we accepted

Certainty over maximum reach. Lena chose 15 minutes for same-day offers, with no new offer inside 15 minutes of the appointment.

Chosen: one exclusive offer

Benefit

One clear holder. Decline or timeout automatically advances the waitlist.

Cost

An unanswered offer holds the opening for up to 15 minutes before the next person gets a turn.

A suitable appointment before queue position

“Only contact people whose recorded availability covers the opening.”

Lena, customer discovery conversation

Flexible matching

Could reach more people, but depends on unconfirmed availability or a stylist compromise.

Chosen matching rule

Same service. Availability covers the opening. Respect a required stylist. Then offer to the oldest eligible request.

The tradeoff

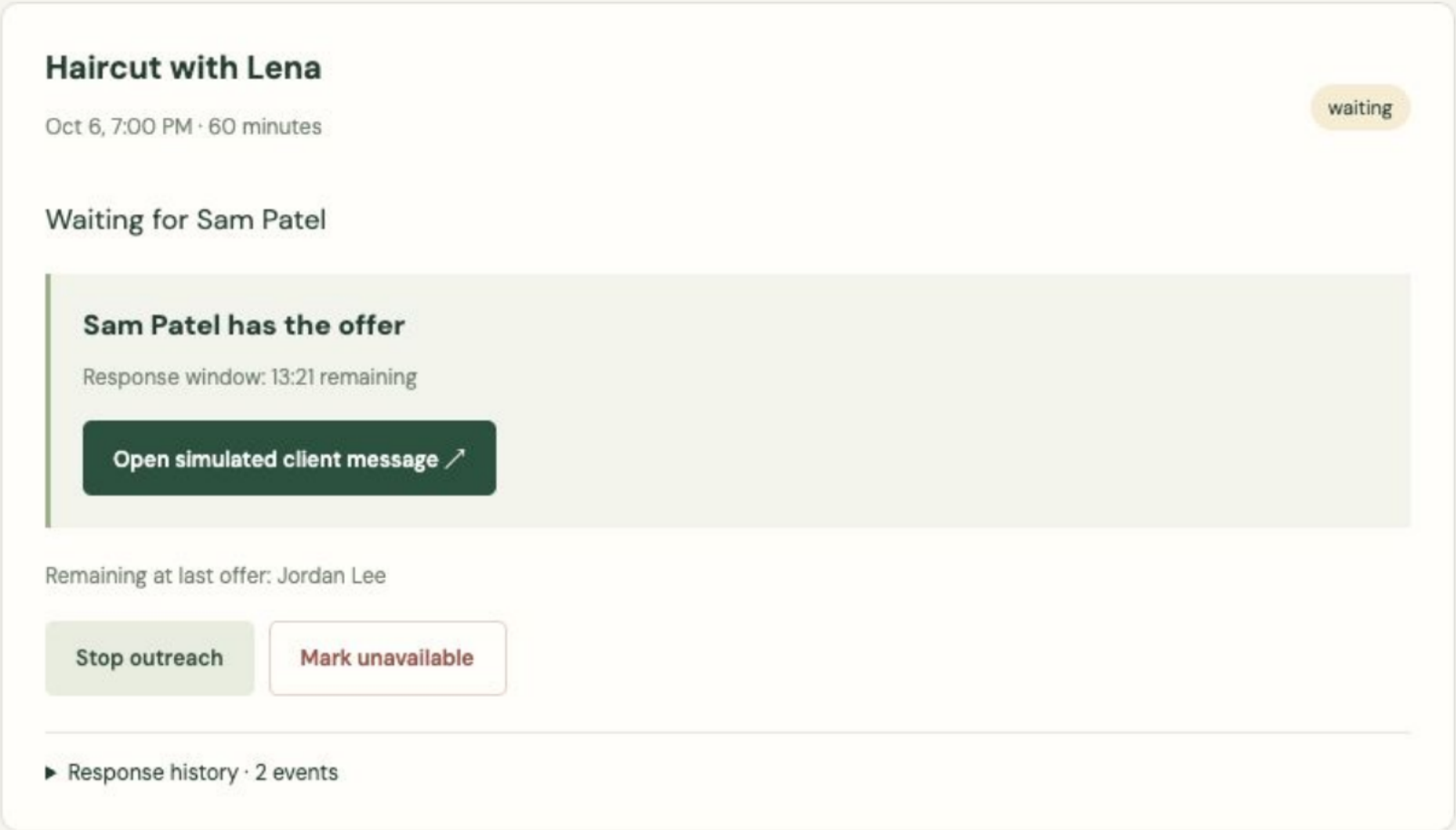
A smaller pool of clients, with fewer unsuitable offers. Staff can confirm flexibility before including someone.

Fairness continues after the offer

Declines and timeouts keep their place for future openings. Acceptance removes the request. Skip clients already considering another offer.

What you and your client actually see

For staff: a held opening, countdown and stop controls



Actual local prototype. Fictional clients. Messages are simulated.

For the client: a private invitation

A PRIVATE INVITATION FOR Sam Patel

A little time,
just for you.



Local prototype · This private screen simulates a text message. Square updates are handled by salon staff.

Temporal keeps the deadline and offer history durable. One workflow coordinates claims across openings and rejects expired or duplicate replies.

How we prove it works, then improve it

Today: sample clients and simulated messages. Square updates remain manual. Live SMS, Square integration and production authentication are excluded.

1. Test together

Lena creates an opening. Carla plays the client. Check matching and waitlist order, then accept or decline.

Let an offer expire. Try a late reply, staff cancellation and competing offers. Check the outcome and history.

Restart the Worker while waiting. Confirm the process resumes without losing the offer.

2. Agree the evidence

Test gate: every scenario behaves as agreed. Zero duplicate bookings or expired-offer acceptances.

Pilot measures: filled openings ÷ eligible cancellations; staff minutes per opening; booking conflicts.

Log results in a shared sheet. Compare with the current manual process over a similar period. Agree targets first.

3. Build toward a pilot

Before real clients: add secure access, SMS delivery and retries, and a reliable Square booking check/write.

Then: run a small supervised pilot. Keep staff able to stop outreach. Review failures and metrics weekly.

Later options: waitlist editing, delivery alerts, reporting and configurable response windows.